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Summary

An established international business and finance leader for large scale (up to £2.2billion) complex businesses in construction, facilities management and consultancy. Strong commercial operator with proven excellent leadership and management skills with a record of driving turnaround and change, building and leading teams of up to 450 and improving working capital.

Areas of Expertise

Working capital | Financial management & reporting | Stakeholder management | Risk management | Team management | Change and transformation of people, systems & process | Acquisition, integration & transformation | Operational Excellence | Digital Strategy | Business improvement

Key Achievements

April 2024 – Present – worked on large potential acquisition of ISG and developed the business strategy and 5 year plan. Designated Group MD role following successful completion of the acquisition.

ISG Group – Main Board role responsible for Business Change, Business Intelligence and Operational Excellence in addition to standard CFO responsibilities. Introduced data driven decision making based on consistent operational KPI's and new 'Continuous Improvement' tool kit and mindset.

Carillion Services – developed 3 year business plan challenging sector MD assumptions, reviewing market and competitor analysis to optimise the business performance.

AECOM Europe & Africa Consulting – rewrote bid management risk review process with suite of standard documents and gateway process to drive bidding of profitable work aligned with the strategy.

Integration of the URS business into the existing business. Duplicate management roles eliminated and centralized support functions savings in excess of £15m per annum and shut down two loss making businesses saving circa £10m per annum.

CarillionTelent JV – Operational change programme for a £365m Joint Venture working for BT Openreach delivered turnaround from annualised loss of £12m to annual profit of £12m.

Carillion Planned Maintenance – turnaround of the Planned Maintenance business rewrote the strategic plan, including review of sectors and contracts. Exited small scale sub-optimal contracts, reduction in headcount of 750 out of 3000 and debt recovery returned business to profitability and aged debt recovery.

Work Experience

Buchanan Consulting SW Ltd. — April 2024 to present

Financial and general business advisory specializing in M&A, integration, transformation and financial re-engineering

Assignment 1 April 2024 to present – Working closely with the acquirer on a large potential acquisition of a large (circa £2bn) privately owned business. Developed and negotiated the initial high level HoT's and subsequently leading the detailed legal, financial and tax due diligence for the buy side team. In addition worked closely with the owner to develop the business strategy and 5 year plan with a detailed first 90 day plan including Strategy on a Page incorporating business structure, KPI's, business improvement, communications and reporting plans.

ISG Limited — March 2019 to March 2024

ISG was a privately owned (quasi Private Equity) Construction and Fit Out business with revenue of circa £2.2bn with operations Internationally in the UK, Western Europe, Middle East and Singapore and delivered hyperscale projects in other regions. It operated in the public and private sector in the UK and mainly private sector in other geographies with circa 3,500 employees.

Strategic Initiatives – Lead — November 2023 to March 2024

Having stepped down from the Board agreed to stay on for a short period of time to work directly with the CEO on strategic initiatives in particular the review and sale of parts of the business. Successfully negotiated the sale of the Singapore business to the management team generating £6m of cash for the Group.

Group CFO — January 2021 to November 2023

Role & Achievements

- Member of the Board reporting to the CEO with a strong line to the owners CFO and direct relationship with the owner
- Responsible for external relationships with our Banks, Sureties, Auditors and Insurers
- Reviewed & improved all governance policies and procedures including Whistleblowing Policy and process to ensure fit for purpose
- Oversaw the production of the Annual Report and Accounts
- Reviewed and initiated business and working capital improvement throughout the project lifecycle moved DSO from 39 days to 29 days within a year
- Developed a more robust approach to the 3-year business planning process whilst keeping it efficient and relevant, including improved analysis and reporting
- Lead a Finance team of circa 120, developed the team to provide succession and implemented career development and progression programmes. Improved the consistency and usage of the finance shared service and expanding to look at overseas location support to drive efficiencies. Reduced headcount by 15% saving circa £1m
- Responsible for IT, Legal, Company Secretariat (including Business Assurance), Business Change, Business Intelligence and until recently Operational Excellence
- Built and hired (both internal and external candidates) the Operational Excellence programme and team to provide groupwide business improvements in scheduling, quality and absolute completion process. By consolidating teams into central services reduced headcount by circa 25%.
- Embedded a continuous improvement culture and standard lessons learned approach to doing business. Included development of the data and digital strategy to support the drive for business improvement with data driven decision making and relevant KPI reporting and data insights
- Initiated and managed the retender process for the annual audit programme saving £200k
- Developed a more robust approach to change management by introducing a standard approach with specialist small central support team for large change projects and oversight from a Business Change

Board to ensure change is delivered on time, on budget and ROI is delivered including delivery of new HR system and upgrade to Finance system ensuring high levels of adoption and compliance
- Introduced a new approach to payment security and saved £400k per annum in credit insurance fees whilst providing an extremely robust approach to security that ensures the business is protected
- IT improvement programme including hiring of new CIO and supporting him in development of the IT strategy and the programme of work to update and re-platform the whole IT infrastructure in the Cloud. Includes a wholesale retraining exercise with current team to provide opportunities for them to develop with the strategy and improved efficiency allowing a 15% reduction in headcount
- Sponsor of the Race and Faith network to support the work that the focus group are completing including 'courageous conversations' a programme to support line managers and their development in relation to diversity and equity in the workplace

Finance Director Global Engineering (T/O £650m) — March 2019 to December 2020

ISG Global Engineering was a construction business specializing in construction with a high engineering content working mainly in the Datacentre, Health & Sciences and R&D sectors operating in the UK and Europe.

Role & achievements:

- Member of the SMT, reporting to the Global Engineering COO (functional line Group CFO)
- Led a team of 25 finance staff and created a European shared finance Hub to improve the finance support to the business through a period of large growth
- Drove business and working capital improvement throughout the project lifecycle DSO reduced from 40 days to 29 days
- Initiated and drove the development long-term business strategy to provide a more resilient future for the business taking current capability to complimentary adjacent sectors and looking to expand into new geographies
- Put in place a sustainable framework and new country entry processes, particularly around employment compliance providing assurance and brand protection to ISG and its clients

Freelance – Business Start-up Support — July 2018 to March 2019

Worked closely with an entrepreneurial mortgage advisor to start a mortgage advisory business from scratch. Developed compliant systems and processes to manage the data collection and privacy arrangements for an FCA regulated brokerage. Dealt with clients and lenders to set up relationships and build trust in the business.

Carillion plc — November 2016 to July 2018

Carillion plc was a FTSE 250 support services and construction company with revenues Internationally of £5.2bn in the UK, Canada and the Middle East.

Support to PwC and Official Receiver — January 2018 to July 2018

Worked closely with the PWC team to maximise the value realised from sale of businesses and or sale, completion or transfer of contracts. This included detailed work to put together final accounts on contracts to maximise the value and support the commercial discussions. In particular was responsible for putting together cases on 3 large Joint Ventures for disposal.

Chief Cash Officer — October 2017 to January 2018

Role & achievements:

- After a major re-organisation, took on a newly created Group-wide role supporting the Group's Transformation Officer and CFO at a time when managing cash, liquidity and banking covenants had become of critical importance
- Managed the Group's headroom position; established a daily receipts and payments process to bring greater rigour; directed and worked closely with Group Treasury & external advisors

- Provided visibility of funding drawdown requirements as part of managing communication with the banks and supported lender reporting
- Drove delivery of Group cash performance, holding businesses accountable for action plans focusing on large receipts & supported commercial negotiations on large claims

Finance Director Carillion Services (T/O £1.4bn) **November 2016 to September 2017**

Carillion Services was a £1.4bn diverse FM service business with a mixture of private and public sector contracts ranging in value from £400m pa to sub £1m pa including 3 large joint ventures.

Role & achievements:

- Member of the SMT, reporting to the Carillion Services CEO (functional line Group CFO)
- Led a Finance team of 150, rebuilding the team and created a shared finance Hub creating savings of £2.6m per annum whilst improving finance support to the business
- Drove business and working capital improvement reducing Aged WIP & debt by more than £60m in 6 months
- Initiated and drove a full balance sheet review and review of accounting policies in the Services business within a month of joining
- Chaired the Steering Committee and acted as the driving force for large scale business wide cost reduction programme with target annualised savings of c£50m
- Led the annual three-year business planning process with Work Winning Director, liaising with and challenging the Sector MDs, reviewing market and competitor analysis to inform the output and assessing strategic options to optimise business performance

AECOM March 2014 to October 2016

A Fortune 500 US multi-national providing design, consulting, construction, environmental, project and programme management and management services globally with more than 85,000 employees.

SVP & CFO, Europe & Africa (revenue US$1.7bn)

Role & achievements:

- FD for the semi-autonomous Europe & Africa region (over 40 countries), reporting to the Regional CEO, and member of the EMEAI Senior Management Team
- Remit covered operational finance, financial planning & analysis, controllership, tax, shared services, treasury and risk management (co-Chair of the UK, Europe and Africa risk committees)
- Responsible for full SOX compliance, including 100% compliance sign off throughout period of tenure and managing audit relationships including complex local GAAP compliance throughout Europe and Africa
- Team of c450 Finance staff including the EMEAI Shared Service centre
- Built strong relationships at Group centre/HQ (Los Angeles) and across the business
- Led the integration of two finance shared service centres to one following the URS acquisition with systems and process changes implemented on to the Oracle system to drive greater efficiency and cost savings in the UK of circa £3.5m and continued to drive further efficiency by expanding coverage into Europe and Africa to drive additional consistency and overall savings of circa £15m including office location reductions.
- Managed Aecom's most complex currency positions with support from Group Treasury in Ireland and Middle East, particularly Eastern European currency volatility; proposed a new approach to currency risk management
- Implemented new risk management process in the UK including introducing new finance roles to support the work winning teams
- Led working capital improvement achieved by setting targets at granular level to drive performance at the contract level, driving focus on understanding cash flow at outset of bid and ensuring operational teams understood the cash imperative and the cost of capital. As a result the whole culture of the business changed so that working capital became a business responsibility rather than a finance responsibility

- Rebuilt an underperforming, demotivated and 'change fatigued' team, transforming it into a highly professional, motivated and diverse group known for working collaboratively. This included full assessment process to match people to the right roles and the creation of new roles (including a European Financial Controller and in work winning)
- Technical improvements implemented on R&D tax credits receiving more than £5m of credits in the first year of implementation and leading the IFRS 15 preparation work.

Carillion plc — 1995 to February 2014

Joined Carillion pre-demerger as a part time unqualified bookkeeper looking after the books and records of the internal Travel Agency and a part-owned hotel. In recognition for my achievements in these areas, invited to take up a more senior full-time role, whilst supported through attaining my CIMA qualification at night school and day release.

SVP & CFO, Carillion Canada (T/O CAN$1.0bn) — January 2012 to February 2014

Role & achievements:

- Member of SMT reporting to Carillion Canada President & CEO (functional reporting line to the Group Finance Director)
- Led a Finance team of 38 to provide finance support to the business, working as a partner to the President & CEO
- Responsible for local banking and leasing
- Responsible for the audit relationship in Canada
- Overhauled all the financial and commercial reporting driving improvements in the budget and reforecasting processes
- Implemented and led a more disciplined and consistent review, monitoring and challenge of contract performance ensuring contract leads were accountable
- Roll out and implementation of the finance system Viewpoint.
- Implemented strong working capital management processes including optimising subcontractor payment terms versus pricing.

Programme Director, CarillionTelent JV — July 2011 to December 2011

- Ran a wholesale operational change programme for a £365m Joint Venture working for BT Openreach as its main delivery partner for the management, maintenance and upgrading of its broadband network. This included a transformation of the operating model as well as cost cutting programme to take out £8m per annum. Achieved largely on time and delivered all objectives.

Finance Director, Planned Maintenance and Group Services (T/O £320m) — September 2010 to June 2011

- FD for a maintenance services business with a large engineering workforce of c3,000.
- Partnered with the MD to lead a turnaround transformation of the business taking immediate tactical steps to reduce losses whilst developing the strategy to return to profit and ultimately moved to integrate into Carillion Services
- Led a Finance team of 140 people including Accounts Payable, Payroll, Credit Control, Accounting, Financial Planning & Analysis, delivered systems and process changed and outsourced transactional finance

Finance Director, Group Services — April 2009 to August 2010

- Reporting to the Group FD and tasked with resolving Group Services financial control and reporting issues.
- Delivered a £10m cost reduction programme within Group Services.
- Retained responsibility of the Building 'Fit for the Future' strategy cost saving programme to deliver a further £10m cost reduction.

Finance Director, Carillion Building (T/O £1.4bn) — January 2008 to March 2009

- Member of SMT reporting to the Executive Director for Building with a functional reporting line to the Group Finance Director.
- Significant change and integration programme – appointed to integrate two businesses followed by the integration of the acquired Alfred McAlpine activities. Included a new accounting system and a move to an outsourced model for HR and Finance.
- Led a Finance team of 60, including 3 processing centres

Finance Director, Carillion National Building (T/O £850m) **June 2005 to December 2007**

- Reporting to Business Unit MD and Group Finance Director, led a team of 4 across financial and commercial reporting, budgeting & reforecasting, the business planning process as well as reviewing and challenging contract performance.
- Led roll out of Oracle and financial integration of Mowlem activities.
- Introduced payment security process including negotiating directly with customers.
- Implemented strong working capital processes, optimising subcontractor payment terms.

Group Financial Controller **2004 to May 2005**

- Responsible for Group management reporting including cash, budgeting, forecasting and business planning; managed the external audit relationship; supported the Group Finance Director with all financial Board reporting. Developed standard format for technical position papers.